First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 11
Sacred Earth, Sacred Soul ~ Sacred Compassion
15 November 2026

Preaching: LVF
Worship Leading: ML & Juniper Fayazova & Garfield Morris

Strips of paper in programs for prayers

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Michael & … center chancel]

Welcome **ML**

Words of Gathering **Juniper Fayazova & Garfield Morris**
On this day, Holy One, help us to remember
that all things are born of you.

We carry within us your light and your life.
In the mystery of matter
and deep in the cells of our souls
are your longings for oneness.

The oneness of the universe
vast and vibrating with the sound of its beginning.
The oneness of the earth
greening and teeming as a single body.
The oneness of the human soul
a sacred countenance in infinite form.

On this day, grant us your longings for oneness, Holy One,
amidst life's glorious multiplicities.
[jphilipnewell]

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering.

Hymn of Gathering** ***Praise with Joy the World's Creator LAUDA ANIMA

_2021-10-10

- #9 in Pilgrim Hymnal ("Praise, My Soul, the King of Heaven")
- LYRICS (OW)
- PDF
- PRINTED COPIES

Praise with joy the world's Creator, God of justice, love, and peace,
Source and end of human knowledge, grace bestowing without cease.
Celebrate the Maker's glory, power to rescue and release.

Praise to Christ who feeds the hungry, frees the captive, finds the lost,
Heals the sick, upsets religion, fearless both of fate and cost.
Celebrate Christ's constant Presence - Friend and Stranger, Guest and Host.

Praise the Spirit sent among us, liberating truth from pride,
Forging bonds where race or gender, age or nation dare divide.
Celebrate the Spirit's treasure - foolishness none dare deride.

Praise the Maker, Christ, and Spirit, one God in Community,
Calling **Christians** to embody oneness and diversity.
Thus the world shall yet believe when shown **Christ's** vibrant unity.

[Michael center chancel]

***Prayer of Awareness** **ML**

Holy One,
as you open our eyes that we might see the needs of others;
open also our ears, that we may hear their cries;
and our hearts so that they need not be without comfort.

Let us not be afraid to defend the weak because of the
anger of the strong,
nor afraid to defend the poor because of the
anger of the rich.
Show us where love and hope and faith are needed,
and use us to bring them to those places.

And then, Holy One, open us with your compassion
so that in the days to come,
we will be able to do the work
of peace with you, and with each other.

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!
Amen.

***Introit** An Affirmation Andrew Carter
Commonwealth Youth Choir with Cathedral Choir Text: Stephen Grellet
Brandon Harris, *Director of Commonwealth Youth Choir*

I expect to pass through this world but once. Any good thing, therefore, that I can do, or any kindness I can show, or any service I can render to any soul, of human or animal, let me do it now. Let me not defer or neglect it, for I shall not pass this way again.

[... to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer** **Juniper Fayazova & Garfield Morris**

Let us now share these words for the Lord's Prayer, adapted from the New Zealand Book of Prayer…

Eternal Spirit,
Life-Giver, Pain-Bearer, Love-Maker,
Source of all that is and that shall be.
Father and Mother of us all,
Loving God, in whom is heaven:
The hallowing of your name
echo through the universe!
The way of your justice be followed
By all peoples of the world!
Your heavenly will be done
By all created beings!
Your commonwealth of peace and freedom
Sustain our hope and come on earth.

With the bread we need for today, feed us.
In the hurts we absorb from one another, forgive us.
In times of temptation and test, strengthen us.
From trials too great to endure, spare us.
From the grip of all that is evil, free us.

For you reign in the glory of power that is love and grace,
now and forever. Amen.

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**
Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Michael center chancel]
***Passing of the Peace** **ML**
Hear now these Words of Peace…
Peace in the longing,

peace in the leaving,
peace in the letting go.
In every step, peace.

Today
now
this moment
may we see
the presence of God
in the face of another
and, in our seeing,
may we find life. [adapt/jrichardson]

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are now invited to share this greeting with those near you.

Please be seated

[... to lectern]

Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition ***from Ezekiel***
Juniper Fayazova & Garfield Morris

Hear now these words from the Prophet Ezekiel in the Hebrew Bible…

This is the witness of the people.
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph short transition Michael center chancel]

Prayers with the People **ML**

Invitation to Silence and Prayer
It is in the temple of our inner being,
in the temple of our bodies,
in the temple of earth, sea, and sky,
in the great temple of the universe
that we look for the light that was in the beginning,
the mighty fire that blazes still from the heart of life,
glowing in the whiteness of the moon, glistening in the night stars,
hidden in the black earth, concealed in the unknown depths of our souls.

Often we fail to remember where to look to find ourselves,
and each other.

This morning as we come to this time of silence and meditation
let us remember who we are and with gratitude,
open ourselves to the great compassion of God
that is among us, around us, and within us.

Aas we share these moments of silence, we are invited to write the prayers of our hearts for our lives and the life of our world on the slips of paper in our programs. If you are online, please share your prayers by emailing prayers@fccla.org.

Then, as the music begins, we are invited to come forward to share our prayers here in the bowl, and to light candles signifying our prayers, for ourselves, those we love and hold dear - and for the life of the world.

Let us now be in silence, together.

Silence

Prayer of Our Hearts
For the wisdom that fashioned the universe
and can be read in earth's dark depths
and in heaven's infinity of lights
Thanks be to you, O God.

For the wisdom of teachers before us
and their words and imaginative seeing,
for the wisdom of the those we have known
and their silence and humility of speech,
and for wisdom's wellspring in our own souls
and in the soul of every human being
from which ancient truths and new realizations spring forth,
Thanks be to you.

Let wisdom unfold in our hearts and minds
and in the people of every nation.
Let us see the foundations for a new harmony
within us and between us,
the foundations for a recovered unity
with the earth and all its creatures,
for the ground of life is in you, O God,
the ground of all life is in you.
Amen and Amen.

[Christoph transition for choir]

Meditation Anthem Recovery Family Molly Pease
Molly Pease, *Vocals*

[Christoph transition Laura to pulpit, choir to seats]

Sermon ***Sacred Compassion*** **LVF**

[Christoph transition … to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity
In this time of worship,
here among this gathered people,
we have been given comfort and challenge,
mystery and grace,
to provide for nourishment
each step of our journey.

As people who are truly thankful,
we give from our hearts,
and from our resources to make certain
this place of welcome and belonging
is available for everyone -
whether we come from near or far.

Today, we invite you to support our Community Gardens & Urban Farm here at the Cathedral. These spaces across our 5-acre campus have been intentionally transformed for the growing and sharing of food with our beloved neighbors across Koreatown and Westlake. This food, chosen specifically for the culinary traditions of our neighbors, includes: over 60 fruit trees, a medicinal, culinary, and butterfly garden with herbs for cooking, healing, and struggling Monarch populations, and over 30 raised beds containing varieties of greens and healthy vegetables.

Thank you for joining us in this expansive vision, as we continue to share all that we have and all that we are.

Gardens QR Code

Offertory Anthem Abendlied Josef Rheinberger
Laude
Stay with us, for the night is almost here and the daylight is almost gone

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**
From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!
[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[... to lectern toward end of doxology]

***Offering Prayer**
PAUSE and then begin
Thanks be to you, O God,
for the stirrings of new life in us this day,
from rising from the dreams of the night
to a fresh flowing of energy,
for the vitality that awakened our bodies
and the desires that stir our souls.

Let us know the power for life that is in us,
the life-force that is in our senses,
and the might that is within our hearts.

Let us know you as the source of such force
and be wise to its true streams and false currents.

As we leave this sacred time and place,
let us serve love with our strength this day,
let us serve love with our strength.
In heart and mind and body this day,
let us serve love.
[JPhilipNewelladapt/lvf]
May it be so.
May it be so for all of us.
Amen and Amen!

Please be seated

[Laura & Michael center chancel]

Life at First Church **ML & LVF**

Words of Blessing **LVF**
The blessings of the sun
the blessings of the moon
the blessings of east and west
to guide us on this way

to lighten our eyes
to strengthen our will and our loving.

The blessings of earth
the blessings of air
the blessings of fire and water
to fill us with heaven
to free us with mercy
to stir us with flames of compassion.

May it ever be so.
May it ever be so for all of us!

Choral Response Lean on Me Bill Withers
Cathedral Choir

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music- Dr. Ianthe Marini